

LinkedIn Post — Team Growth / Delegation WHY

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My team went from 5 to 20 people. I thought I was ready.

I had the org chart figured out. I had hired the right people. What I did not have was anyone who knew why the invisible work existed.

For two years I had been doing things for my team that I never named. Tending relationships with internal customers. Translating what we built into language the business understood. Making sure the right people knew why our work mattered. My team did the work. I handled everything around it.

When the team doubled, I could not cover it anymore. And nobody was behind me to pick up the pieces. My original team lost ground for years. Not because the work got worse. Because the context behind the critical work had lived only inside me.

Most leaders think about delegation as a task problem. The real problem is context. You can hand someone a task in five minutes. Handing them the reason that task exists takes a real conversation.

When is the last time you explained the why behind the work you are asking someone to own?

#leadership #engineeringmanagement #techleadership #managingup